

# Since vs For

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet &amp; answer key

## Quick answer

Use 'since' and 'for' to say how long, usually with the present perfect. Use:

- 1 Since + a starting point — since 2020, since Monday, since I arrived.
- 2 For + a period of time — for two hours, for ten years, for a long time.

*Quick test: if it's a point in time, use 'since'; if it's a length of time, use 'for'.*

## At a glance

| Word  | Goes with                         | Examples                                                 |
|-------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| since | a point in time (when it started) | since 9am, since 2019, since Monday, since I was a child |
| for   | a length of time (how long)       | for ten minutes, for three days, for years               |

## Learning objectives

- Can choose 'since' (starting point) or 'for' (duration) correctly (CEFR B1).
- Can use both with the present perfect for continuing situations.
- Can correct the typical swap between since and for.



# Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Since vs For · CEFR B1

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

1. I've lived here \_\_\_\_ 2020.

- |          |           |
|----------|-----------|
| A. since | B. for    |
| C. from  | D. during |

2. We've been married \_\_\_\_ ten years.

- |          |        |
|----------|--------|
| A. since | B. for |
| C. from  | D. by  |

3. She's been ill \_\_\_\_ Monday.

- |           |          |
|-----------|----------|
| A. for    | B. since |
| C. during | D. by    |

4. He waited \_\_\_\_ an hour and then left.

- |          |        |
|----------|--------|
| A. since | B. for |
| C. from  | D. at  |

5. I've known them \_\_\_\_ I was a child.

- |           |          |
|-----------|----------|
| A. for    | B. since |
| C. during | D. when  |

6. Correct this: 'I've had this car since five years.'

- |                    |                      |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| A. for five years  | B. during five years |
| C. from five years | D. by five years     |

7. They've been studying \_\_\_\_ two hours.

- |          |        |
|----------|--------|
| A. since | B. for |
| C. from  | D. at  |

8. Nothing has changed \_\_\_\_ last summer.

- |           |          |
|-----------|----------|
| A. for    | B. since |
| C. during | D. by    |

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'I started this job in 2019 and I'm still here.'

- |                                 |                               |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A. I've worked here since 2019. | B. I work here for 2019.      |
| C. I worked here since 2019.    | D. I've worked here for 2019. |

10. We haven't seen each other \_\_\_\_ ages.

- |          |        |
|----------|--------|
| A. since | B. for |
| C. from  | D. by  |

# Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. since** — '2020' is a starting point, so use 'since'.
2. **B. for** — 'Ten years' is a length of time, so use 'for'.
3. **B. since** — 'Monday' is a starting point, so use 'since'.
4. **B. for** — 'An hour' is a period, so use 'for'.
5. **B. since** — 'Since' can be followed by a clause that marks the starting point: 'since I was a child'.
6. **A. for five years** — 'Five years' is a length of time, so use 'for five years'.
7. **B. for** — 'Two hours' is a length of time, so use 'for'.
8. **B. since** — 'Last summer' is a starting point, so use 'since'.
9. **A. I've worked here since 2019.** — Started in 2019 and continuing = present perfect + since (a starting point).
10. **B. for** — 'Ages' means a long period, so use 'for'.